

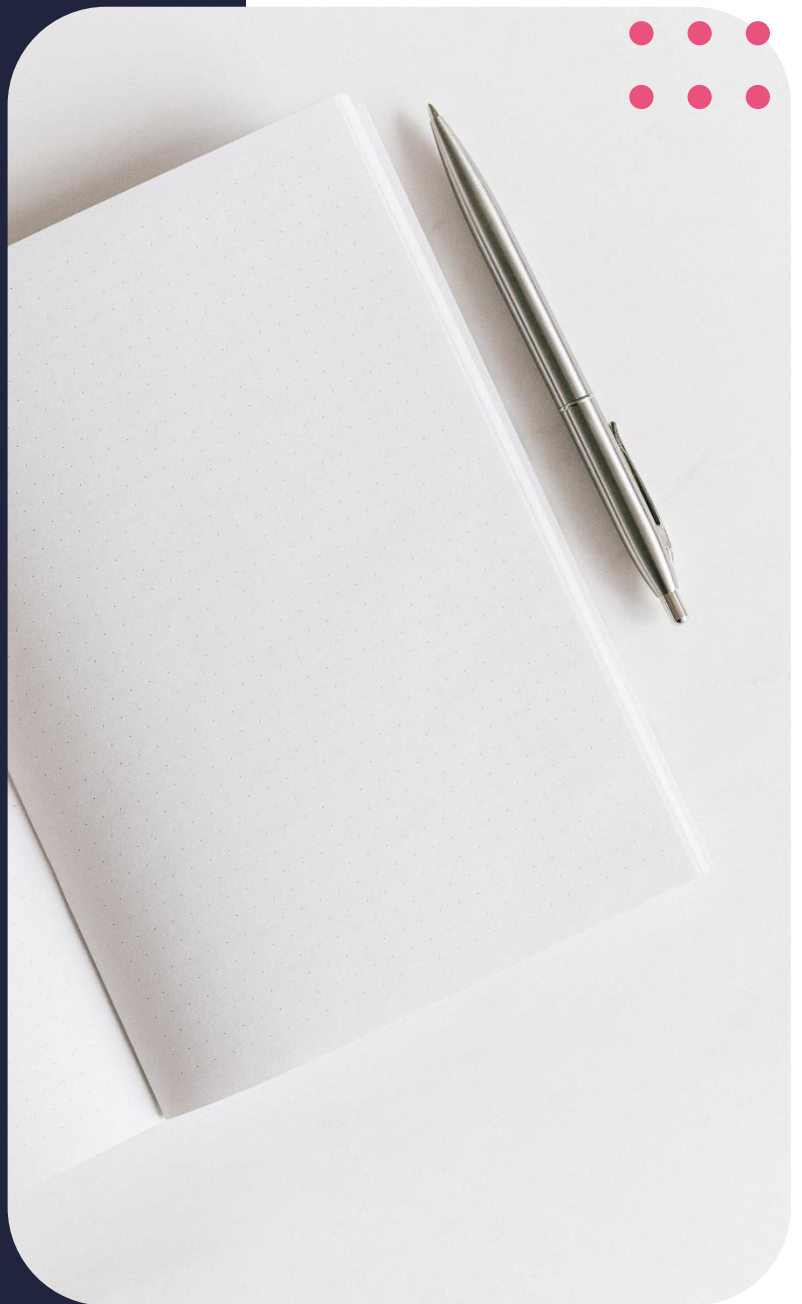
Diploma i Leadership & Management

Lead with Vision, Values, and Purpose



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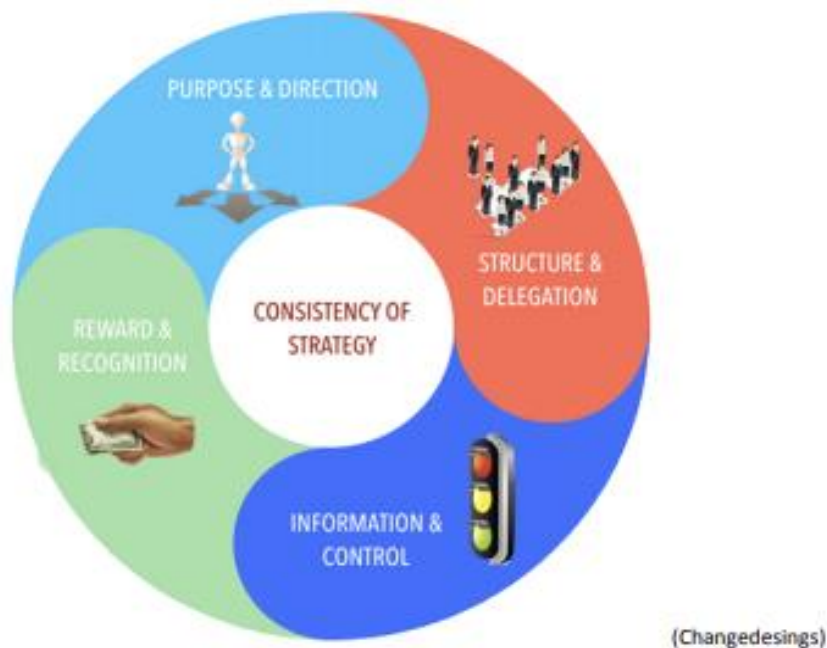
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Lesson 6 Objectives

- Leadership and strategic alignment
- The importance of vision in leadership
- Why leaders have purpose

Lesson Introduction



According to (transaprentchoice): “understanding strategic alignment starts with understanding what strategy really is. Most people think of “vision statements” and “mission statements” as being “strategy” but they are only a small part of the “strategy story”. Your mission and vision are simply statements about what your organization is for and where the executives would like to take it.”

Key reading materials

- <https://trainingindustry.com/articles/professional-development/4-steps-to-achieve-strategic-alignment/>
- <https://www.nist.gov/blogs/blogrige/so-what-strategic-alignment>

Top learning and development skills to have

Exercises to assess strategic vision alignment

Please note that these exercises are provided by (marianodebernardi)

Exercise 1 – Q-Sort

Check the strategic vision is shared by comparing the priorities of the board, management team, and any other key staff.

1. Get the Board or CEO to make a list of at least 18 specific goals, in order of priority.
2. Create a new list of these goals in random order. Give this list to all the management team and key staff and ask them to organise them by priority.
3. Calculate the correlation between the CEO or Board's list and that of each of the others (easily done in an Excel worksheet)
4. The result can be presented in a visual manner with arrows pointing in the same or different directions or as a football field with players kicking into the goal (correlation 1) or in other directions.

Exercise 2 – Strategic Barriers Perception

Determine the reasons for the lack of alignment by questioning the perception of each executive regarding the company's main strategic issues.

1. Make cards for each strategic issue with a brief and clear description of the issue at the top. At the bottom of the card describe a positive scenario (colored green) and a negative scenario (colored red). Typical issues could be market, technologies, competition, customer habits, and trends, suppliers, or whatever is considered an important variable for the company's strategy.
2. Question every member of the management team about the importance of each factor and which description (positive or negative) best describes the current situation of the company.
3. Compare these perceptions to see where divergences occur. A bar graph with the importance given to each factor and another bar graph for positive/negative perception will demonstrate how everyone views the current situation in a visual manner.

Action

If the result is that the strategic vision is not shared (and usually it isn't) then it's essential to work on strategic communication and debate. Hold workshops with all the staff, comprising in-depth discussions on every aspect of the strategy until a strategic map is defined and goals are broken down with who is responsible and dates by which tasks and objectives should be accomplished. Any misunderstandings or grey areas need to be dealt with and eliminated.

You can conduct the workshops following this index:

1. Mission
 2. Vision
 3. Key factors for success
 4. Organisational Values
 5. Strategic Goals
 6. Strategic Map – Responsibilities
 7. Goals Roll Down
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8. Strategic Map
9. Strategic Plan (with dates & person who is responsible)

Vision explored

Vision statement tools

There are several tools, templates, and resources to use that will help you when writing your vision statement. You can also look for an expert to help you write the vision statement. Make sure to explore the different options to find the correct solution for your company.

Here we have some tools, templates, and resources that you can make use of:

- Smartsheet: Vision statement worksheet
- Diggles Creative: Brand vision worksheet
- Whole Whale: Nonprofit vision and mission statement worksheet
- Lone Star College System: Worksheets for developing mission and vision statements
- Khorus: Mission, vision and values worksheets

Examples of company visions statements

Examples of different visions statements as displayed by (businessnewsdaily)

- Amazon: "To be Earth's most customer-centric company where customers can find and discover anything they might want to buy online."
 - Ben & Jerry's: "Making the best ice cream in the nicest possible way."
 - Caterpillar: "Our vision is a world in which all people's basic needs – such as shelter, clean water, sanitation, food and reliable power – are fulfilled in an environmentally sustainable way, and a company that improves the quality of the environment and the communities where we live and work."
 - Google: "To provide access to the world's information in one click."
 - Habitat for Humanity: "A world where everyone has a decent place to live."
 - Hilton Hotels & Resorts: "To fill the earth with the light and warmth of hospitality."
 - IKEA: "To create a better everyday life for the many people."
 - Intel: "If it's smart and connected, it's best with Intel." 5
 - LinkedIn: "Create economic opportunity for every member of the global workforce."
 - Oxfam: "A world without poverty."

 - Patagonia: "Build the best product, cause no unnecessary harm, use business to inspire and implement solutions to the environmental crisis."
 - Prezi: "To reinvent how people share knowledge, tell stories, and inspire their audiences to act."
 - Samsung: "Inspire the world, create the future."
 - Smithsonian: "By 2022, the Smithsonian will build on its unique strengths to engage and to inspire more people, where they are, with greater impact, while catalysing critical conversation on issues affecting our nation and the world."
 - Southwest Airlines: "To become the world's most loved, most flown and most profitable airline."
 - Sweetgreen: "To inspire healthier communities by connecting people to real food."
 - TED: "Spread ideas." Top tips for writing your vision statement: According to (businessnewsdaily)
 - Make sure that you're projecting for the long-term. Ideally, set up your vision for the next 5-10 years. Use the present tense when writing your statement
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- Make sure that your statement is clear, easy to understand and to the point.
- Make sure that the vision is inspirational and something that you believe in
- Think of your company values and goals when setting up your statement

How to create purpose in the workplace

Correct with employees:

When you have a good understanding of what your employees do and your role as the manager or leader, it will be easier to find your role and purpose. The aim is that you are able to see your role and the value that it adds in the eyes of your employees. This way you can create long-term purpose for yourself.

Make sure that you're learning and growing:

In order to find purpose, you need to be ready for growth and learning. It will help you a lot to find your purpose as you expand your mind and as you embrace growth and change. This will enable you to fully understand where you can improve and use that to build your long-term purpose.

Adopt a collaborative leader action model to leadership

According to (bigtinkedge)

Dan Pontefract, a Big Think expert and Chief Envisioner at TELUS, developed the Collaborative Leader Action Model (CLAM) for TELUS to increase employee engagement through a specific approach to leadership, which it effectively did by nearly 90%.

According to Pontefract, the “six C’s” of successful leadership that are part of the model include the following steps: 1.

1. **Connect.** This step highlights the importance of continuously connecting with people on both an emotional and transformational level.
 2. **Consider.** This entails considering as many options as possible and the leader asking the people around them for their input to make decisions.
 3. **Communicate.** Once the decision has been made, it’s important to communicate it with the people they have been connecting with to keep them in the loop. It’s about being proactive in communication.
 4. **Create.** This is about taking the next step to execute what has been decided and communicated (but doing so in an engaging way).
 5. **Confirm.** This step is the one in which a leader ensures that what has been decided on and communicated to the people that they have connected with has actually been done. This important step helps to keep people focused and also holds them accountable.
 6. **Congratulate.** An often-forgotten step in the leadership process is to celebrate tasks and congratulate people. This involves taking a moment to recognize people and accomplishments rather than simply moving on to the next thing.
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